

Miss Caroline Dawn Ayres
47 The Circuit
Alderley Edge
Cheshire
SK9 7LS

21.9.2025

For the attention of Miss C Ayres

Dear Caroline

Terms of Engagement

This letter sets out the basis on which we will act as your Accountant and is required under the ethical guidelines of The Association of Accounting Technicians.

1. Our Services and Responsibilities

1.1 We shall provide a year end Accountancy service to you, which will include the following, which has been prepared from the information that you have provided. As part of our normal procedures we may request you to provide written confirmation of any information or explanations given to us orally during the course of our work.

- Self assessment for Caroline Ayres prepared from the information you provide.
- Submission of Tax return to HMRC on behalf of Caroline Ayres
- No formal accounts will be prepared

2. Your Responsibilities

1. You have undertaken to make available to us, all accounting records and related financial information necessary for the preparation of the accounts. You will make full disclosure to us of all relevant information.
2. You are responsible for ensuring that, to the best of your knowledge and belief, financial information, whether used by the business or for the accounts, is reliable. You are also responsible for ensuring that the activities of the business are conducted honestly, that its assets are safeguarded, and to establish arrangements to deter fraudulent or other dishonest conduct and to detect any that occur.
3. You are responsible for ensuring that the business complies with the laws and regulations applicable to its activities, to establish arrangements designed to prevent any non-compliance and to detect any that occur.
 - to make a full disclosure to us of all sources of income, allowances and capital transactions and to provide full information as necessary for dealing with your affairs; we will rely on the information and documents being true, correct and complete and will not audit the information of those documents;
 - to respond quickly and fully to our requests for information and to other communications from us;
 - that we can approach such third parties as may be appropriate for information that we consider necessary to deal with your affairs;
 - to provide us with information in sufficient time for your tax return to be completed and submitted according to HMRC deadlines following the end of the tax year. In order to meet this date you agree to provide us with relevant information as an ongoing procedure.

3. Confidentiality and External Review

- 3.1 Arising from the regulatory requirements of the Association of Accounting Technicians (AAT), our work is subject to external review by independent qualified accountants. Accordingly, our client files can be reviewed by an external reviewer, who will be subject to a confidentiality agreement.
- 3.2 Communication between us is confidential and we shall take all reasonable steps to keep confidential your information except where we are required to disclose it by law, by regulatory bodies, by our insurers or as part of an external peer review. Unless we are authorised by you to disclose information on your behalf this undertaking will apply during and after this engagement.

- 3.3 We may, on occasions, subcontract work on your affairs to other tax or accounting professionals. The subcontractors will be bound by our client confidentiality terms.

4. Conflicts of Interest

- 4.1 We will inform you if we become aware of any conflict of interest in our relationship with you or in our relationship with you and another client unless we are unable to do so because of our confidentiality obligations. We have safeguards that can be implemented to protect the interests of different clients if a conflict arises. Where conflicts are identified which cannot be managed in a way that protects your interests then we regret that we will be unable to provide further services.
- 4.2 If there is a conflict of interest that is capable of being addressed successfully by the adoption of suitable safeguards to protect your interests then we will adopt those safeguards. We reserve the right to provide services for other clients whose interests are not the same as yours or are adverse to yours subject of course to the obligations of confidentiality referred to above.

5. Retention of Records

- 5.1 During the course of our work we will collect information from you and others acting on your behalf and will return any original documents to you following preparation of your return. You should retain them for 6 plus current year from the end of the accounting year. This period may be extended if HM Revenue & Customs enquire into your tax return.
- 5.2 Whilst certain documents may legally belong to you, unless you tell us not to, we intend to destroy correspondence and other papers that we store which are more than seven years old, other than documents which we think may be of continuing significance. You must tell us if you require retention of a particular document.

6. Ethical and Practice Guidelines

- 6.1 In accepting the terms of this letter you recognise that we shall comply with our Institute's ethical and practice guidelines.

7 Standard of Service

- 7.1 We aim to provide the best possible service to our clients. If you would like to discuss how our service could be improved please let us know by telephoning Susan Kerby-Skinner.
- 7.2 We undertake to look into any complaint carefully and promptly and do all we can to explain the position to you. We will do everything reasonable to put matters right. Prompt communication enables us to take prompt action on your behalf.
- 7.3 Should you at any stage, feel that you have not received an adequate response to a complaint the circumstances should be brought to the attention of Susan Kerby-Skinner
- 7.4 If we do not answer your complaint to your satisfaction you may take up the matter with the Association of Accounting Technicians.

8 Fees

- 8.1 In much of the work we do we are reasonably able to predict how much time it should take and the appropriate fee for the above work will be £175 to complete the Self assessment for Caroline Ayres using the information provided by yourself and that no other complications should arise with the information provided. Should you decide that you require a full set of accounts, the fee will then be discussed further.
- 8.2 Payment of our application for payment is due on completion of work. We reserve the right to charge a finance charge at the rate of 5% in the case of overdue accounts. We may terminate our engagement and cease acting if payment of any fees billed is unduly delayed. However, it is not our intention to use these arrangements in a way that is unfair or unreasonable.

9. Limitation of Liability

- 9.1 We will provide the professional services outlined in this letter with reasonable care and skill. However, we will not be responsible for any losses, penalties, surcharges, interest or additional tax liabilities arising from the supply by you or others of incorrect or incomplete information, or from the failure by you or others to supply any appropriate information or your failure to act on our advice or respond promptly to communications from us or the tax authorities.

- 9.2 You will not hold our directors and staff, responsible, to the fullest extent permitted by law, for any loss suffered by you arising from any misrepresentation (intentional or unintentional) supplied to us orally or in writing in connection with this agreement. You have agreed that you will not bring any claim in connection with services we provide to you against any of our directors or employees personally.
- 9.3 We have discussed with you the extent of our liability to you in respect of the professional services set out in this letter.

10. Electronic Communication

- 10.1 As Internet communications are capable of data corruption we do not accept any responsibility for changes made to such communications after their despatch. For this reason it may be inappropriate to rely on advice contained in an e-mail without obtaining written confirmation of it. All risks connected with sending commercially sensitive information relating to your business are borne by you and are not our responsibility. If you do not accept this risk, you should notify us in writing that email is not an acceptable means of communication.
- 10.2 E-mail may be used to enable us to communicate with you. As with other means of delivery this carries with it the risk of inadvertent misdirection or non-delivery. It is the responsibility of the recipient to carry out a virus check on any attachments received.

11 Applicable Law

- 11.1 This engagement letter shall be governed by, and construed in accordance with, English Law. The Courts of England shall have exclusive jurisdiction in relation to any claim, dispute or difference concerning the engagement letter and any matter arising from it. Each party irrevocably waives any right it may have to object to any action being brought in those Courts, to claim that the action has been brought in an inconvenient forum, or to claim that those Courts do not have jurisdiction.

12 Intellectual Property Rights

- 12.1 We will retain all copyright in any document prepared by us during the course of carrying out the engagement save where the law specifically provides otherwise.

13 Interpretation

- 13.1 If any provision of our engagement letter or terms of business is held to be void, then that provision will be deemed not to form part of this contract. In the event of any conflict between these terms of business and the engagement letter or appendices, the relevant provision in the engagement letter or schedules will take precedence.

14 Internal Disputes Within a Client

- 14.1 If we become aware of a dispute between the parties who own or are in some way involved in the ownership and management of the business, it should be noted that our client is the business and we would not provide information or services to one party without the express knowledge and permission of all parties. Unless otherwise agreed by all parties we will continue to supply information to the normal place of business. If conflicting advice, information or instructions are received from different parties in the business we will refer the matter back to the business owners and take no further action until they have agreed the action to be taken.

15 Lien

- 15.1 Insofar as we are permitted to so by law or professional guidelines, we reserve the right to exercise a lien over all funds, documents and records in our possession relating to all engagements for you until all outstanding fees and disbursements are paid in full.

16 The Provision of Services Regulations 2009

- 16.1 Details of our professional indemnity insurer and other information can be found in our office reception area.

17 Period of Engagement and Termination

- 17.1 Unless otherwise agreed in our engagement letter, our work will begin when we receive implicit or explicit acceptance of that letter. Except as stated in that letter we will not be responsible for periods before that date.
- 17.2 Each of us may terminate our agreement by giving not less than 21 days notice in writing to the other party except where you fail to cooperate with us or we have reason to believe that you have provided us [or HM Revenue & Customs] with misleading information, in which case we may terminate this agreement immediately. Termination will be without prejudice to any rights that may have accrued to either of us prior to termination.
- 17.3 In the event of termination of our contract, we will endeavour to agree with you the arrangements for the completion of work in progress at that time, unless we are required for legal or regulatory reasons to cease work immediately. In that event, we shall not be required to carry out further work and shall not be responsible or liable for any consequences arising from termination.

18 Disengagement

- 18.1 Should we resign or be requested to resign we will normally issue a disengagement letter to ensure that our respective responsibilities are clear. Should we have no contact with you for a period of 2 years or more we may issue to your last known address a disengagement letter and hence cease to act.

19 Data Protection Act 1998

- 19.1 To enable us or any company associated with us (such companies include, for the avoidance of doubt, companies, persons or entities of any nature whatsoever with which we are associated or allied from time to time) to discharge the services agreed under this engagement, and for other related purposes including update and enhancing client records, analysis for management purposes and statutory return, crime prevention and legal and regulatory compliance, we may obtain, use, process and disclose personal data about you. You have a right of access, under data protection legislation, to the personal data that we hold about you.

20 Proceeds of Crime Act 2002 and Money Laundering Regulations 2007

- 20.1 In common with all accountancy and legal practices, the practice is required by the Proceeds of Crime Act 2002 and the Money Laundering Regulations 2007 to:
- maintain identification procedures for all new clients;
 - maintain records of identification evidence;
 - report, in accordance with the relevant legislation and regulations, to the National Crime Agency (NCA).

21 Contracts (Rights of Third Parties) Act 1999

- 21.1 A person who is not party to this agreement shall have no right under the contracts (Rights of Third Parties) Act 1999 to enforce any term of this agreement. This clause does not affect any right or remedy of any person which exists or is available otherwise than pursuant to that Act.

22 Agreement Terms

- 22.1 Once it has been agreed, this letter will remain effective, from the date of the signature, until it is replaced or terminated. Either party may vary or terminate our authority to act on your behalf at any time without penalty. Notice of termination must be given in writing.
- 22.2 Would you confirm your agreement to the terms set out in this letter by signing and returning. If anything is unclear to you or you require further information please let us know.

Yours sincerely

Susan Lorraine Kerby-Skinner

I agree the terms of this letter

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Miss Caroline Ayres

21.9.2025